

» KEY

- Triassic period
- Jurassic period
- Cretaceous period
- MYA** Million years ago

» 215 MYA

First mammals

The first hairy mammals, such as Megazostrodon, were small and ratlike.

» 195 MYA

First sauropods

Early sauropods were much smaller than their later relatives like Diplodocus, which lived 154 MYA.

» 90 MYA

First snakes

Some reptiles lost their limbs and became the first snakes.

» 80 MYA

First ants

Insects appeared before the dinosaurs, but ants only arrived near the end of the Cretaceous.

» 70 MYA

Tyrannosaurus rex

This king of the reptiles only had four million years on Earth before the dinosaurs became extinct.

» 66 million years ago

Dinosaurs extinct

The end of the Cretaceous saw the extinction of the giant dinosaurs, such as T. rex. Around 70 percent of all animals and plants were wiped out.

» 35 MYA

First dogs

Unlike modern dogs, early dogs had very long tails.

» 60 MYA

First primates

The first primates were small and lived in trees.

» 7 million years ago

First humans

Seven million years ago there was more than one type of humanlike animal. Modern humans didn't appear until as recently as 200,000 years ago.

Modern humans

There are now more than seven billion people living on Earth. Humans live on all seven continents and have even made the leap into space! To see into the ancient past we have to look for fossils and other remains of prehistoric animals.

